

Security Policy

TechNova Pvt. Ltd. — Internal Policy Document

Document Code	Version	Effective Date	Policy Owner
TN-IT-202	2.6	01 April 2026	IT Security Team

Purpose and Scope

This policy sets out how TechNova Pvt. Ltd. protects Company, employee, and customer information, and the security responsibilities of every employee, intern, and contractor. It applies to all information created, processed, or stored on Company systems, devices, or premises, and complements the IT Policy, which covers day-to-day asset and account management.

Data Classification

Classification	Description	Examples
Public	Approved for external release	Marketing content, published blog posts
Internal	For employee use; not for external sharing	Internal wikis, org charts, meeting notes
Confidential	Sensitive business information	Contracts, financials, product roadmaps, source code
Restricted	Highest sensitivity; strict access control	Customer personal data, credentials, security incident details

Employees should handle information according to its classification, including when naming files, sharing links, and choosing who to copy on an email or message.

Access Control Principles

- Access to systems and data is granted on a least-privilege, need-to-know basis tied to an employee's role.
- Access to Confidential and Restricted data requires manager and system-owner approval, logged in the Access Request system.
- Access is reviewed quarterly and revoked promptly when no longer needed (role change, project completion, or exit).
- Sharing your login credentials with anyone, including colleagues or IT, is strictly prohibited.

Physical Security

- Access cards are personal and must not be shared or lent to anyone, including colleagues or visitors.

- Tailgating (allowing someone to follow you through a secured door without their own access) is not permitted; direct visitors to reception instead.
- Visitors must sign in at reception, wear a visitor badge, and be accompanied by an employee in non-public areas at all times.
- A clear-desk approach is expected for Confidential or Restricted material: such documents should not be left visible on a desk when unattended.
- Report a lost or stolen access card to Admin and IT immediately so it can be deactivated.

Device and Endpoint Security

- All Company laptops are encrypted at the disk level and run Company-managed antivirus and endpoint protection; these controls must not be disabled.
- Lock your screen (Windows+L / Cmd+Ctrl+Q) whenever stepping away from your device, in the office or at home.
- Security patches and updates pushed by IT should be installed promptly; devices that stay unpatched beyond the grace period may be restricted from network access.
- Only Company-approved software should be installed; see IT Policy for the Software Request process.

Acceptable Use of Company Data

- Do not copy Confidential or Restricted data to personal devices, personal email, or personal cloud storage.
- Do not use public file-sharing links for Confidential or Restricted content; use permissioned sharing within Company-approved tools.
- Customer data must only be accessed for a legitimate business purpose connected to the employee's role, consistent with TechNova's customer contracts and applicable data-protection law.
- Do not use AI tools outside the Company-approved list to process Confidential or Restricted data, as such tools may retain or expose inputs.

Email and Phishing Awareness

Phishing (fraudulent emails or messages designed to steal credentials or install malware) is one of the most common attack methods TechNova faces. Employees complete mandatory security-awareness training at onboarding and annually thereafter, including simulated phishing exercises. Suspicious emails should be reported using the "Report Phishing" button in the mail client rather than clicked on or forwarded.

Common Warning Signs

- Urgent requests for payment, gift cards, or credential changes, especially claiming to be from leadership.
- Sender address that looks similar to, but not exactly, a known domain.
- Unexpected attachments or links, particularly asking you to "log in" to an unfamiliar page.
- Requests to bypass normal approval processes described in the Expense or Reimbursement Policy.

Incident Reporting

Any suspected security incident — a lost device, a clicked phishing link, unauthorised access, a data leak, or any activity that seems abnormal — must be reported immediately to security@technova.example or via "Help → Report Security Incident" on the HR Portal. Do not attempt to investigate or fix a suspected breach yourself; early, prompt reporting significantly reduces potential impact. There is no penalty for reporting a genuine mistake promptly and in good faith.

Severity	Example	Initial Response Target
Critical	Confirmed unauthorised access to customer data or production systems	Within 1 hour
High	Lost device with Confidential data, credential compromise	Within 4 hours
Medium	Suspicious email reported, minor policy violation	Within 1 working day
Low	General security question or awareness query	Within 3 working days

Remote and Hybrid Work Security

Employees working from home or another remote location must connect to Company systems via VPN, keep their home Wi-Fi network password-protected, and avoid conducting Confidential conversations or leaving Confidential material visible in shared or public spaces. See the Work From Home Policy for the full set of expectations.

Third-Party and Vendor Access

Any vendor or contractor requiring access to TechNova systems or data must be sponsored by an employee, go through a security review appropriate to the access requested, and sign a confidentiality/data-processing agreement before access is granted. Vendor access is time-bound and reviewed at the same cadence as employee access.

Password and Authentication Standards

Password length, complexity, MFA, and rotation requirements are defined in the IT Policy and apply uniformly across all Company systems. Security-sensitive systems (production infrastructure, customer data platforms, finance systems) enforce MFA without exception and may apply additional controls such as IP allow-listing or just-in-time access approval.

Social Engineering Beyond Email

Attackers may also attempt social engineering by phone (pretending to be IT support or a vendor), by SMS ("smishing"), or in person (posing as a delivery person or contractor to gain building access). Employees should verify identity through a known channel before sharing information or granting access, and should feel empowered to decline a request that seems unusual, even if it claims urgency or authority.

Data Retention and Disposal

- Data is retained only as long as needed for business or legal purposes, per the retention schedule maintained by Legal and IT Security for each data category.
- Confidential and Restricted paper documents no longer needed should be shredded using the secure bins provided at each office, not placed in regular waste.
- Devices being retired are wiped and securely erased by IT before reuse, donation, or disposal.
- Customer data is deleted or anonymised in line with the retention terms in the relevant customer contract once it is no longer needed.

Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
All Employees	Follow data-handling rules, complete annual security training, report incidents promptly.
Managers	Ensure their team's access matches current role needs; support incident response for their team.
IT Security Team	Maintain security controls, run access reviews, lead incident response and training.
System Owners	Approve access requests to systems they own; define data retention for that system.

Consequences of Non-Compliance

Violating this policy — including sharing credentials, disabling security controls, or mishandling Confidential/Restricted data — is treated as a serious conduct matter under the Employee Handbook and may result in disciplinary action up to termination, and, where unlawful activity is involved, referral to law enforcement.

Frequently Asked Questions

Question	Answer
What do I do if I click a suspicious link?	Report it immediately to security@technova.example; do not wait or try to fix it yourself.
Can I use my personal Google Drive for work files?	No. Use the Company Google Workspace and follow the data classification rules for sharing.
How often is access reviewed?	Quarterly, plus immediately on role change or exit.
Who do I contact for a security concern?	security@technova.example, or "Help → Report Security Incident" on the HR Portal.

Document Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Change
2.0	Apr 2022	Introduced formal data classification levels.
2.4	Apr 2024	Added AI tool usage restrictions for Confidential/Restricted data.
2.6	Apr 2026	Updated incident severity response targets.